METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Human Capital Development Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Human Capital Development Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Human Capital Development is a Key Issue in the Social Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on their workforce talent requirements and their ability to attract, retain and develop a highly skilled workforce.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	**Human Capital**	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Inability to attract skilled talent to fill role requirements, loss of competitiveness.
- Loss of intellectual and human capital through attrition, key-person risk.
- Increased costs associated with high employee turnover (e.g., recruitment, training).
- Low workforce productivity.

Human Capital Development Key Issue score

The Human Capital Development Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$is the Management score for company i.

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Human Capital Development Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Human Capital Development Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

Component	Sustainability Indicator
Human Capital Development Strategy score	Extent of human resource-related grievance reporting or escalation procedures
	Employee satisfaction survey frequency
	Formal talent pipeline development strategy
Human Capital Development Programs & Initiatives score	Employee equity programs
	Variable performance-based component to pay
	Workforce eligible for paid parental leave policy
	Regular performance appraisals and feedback processes
	Skills and knowledge development training
Human Capital Development Performance score	Employee turnover rate performance relative to peers
	External recognition as employer of choice (last three years)

Human Capital Development Management score

The Human Capital Development Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Human Capital Development Management score - Excluding Controversies:

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$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Human Capital Development Strategy score

The Human Capital Development Strategy score evaluates the company's initiatives to build and manage its workforce through talent pipeline strategies, grievance procedures, and employee feedback mechanisms. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

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- **Extent of human resource-related grievance reporting or escalation procedures**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has an internal reporting channel or escalation procedures for employees to report human resource-related grievances.

- **Employee satisfaction survey frequency**

Definition: The frequency of employee satisfaction surveys. Best practice is at least annually.

- **Formal talent pipeline development strategy**

Definition: Indicates whether a company has a formal talent pipeline development strategy in place, evidenced through structured recruitment programs (such as graduate traineeships, internships, or apprenticeships) and explicit statements linking talent pipeline development to the company's long-term business or workforce strategy.

Human Capital Development Programs & Initiatives score

The Human Capital Development Programs & Initiatives score evaluates the company's initiatives to support employees through benefits, pay structures, equity programs, training, and performance management. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Employee equity programs**

Definition: The extent of eligibility for an employee stock ownership plan and/or an employee stock purchase plan. Best practice is for all permanent employees to have access to such programs to participate.

- **Variable performance-based component to pay**

Definition: Indicates whether non-officer and non-sales staff are eligible for variable performance-based pay, such as bonuses.

- **Workforce eligible for paid parental leave policy**

Definition: Assesses the extent to which the company's workforce is eligible for material non-pay benefits, evaluated through the company's paid parental leave policies, considering both the duration of paid leave and the scope of employee coverage based on publicly available information. The industry-leading practice is when a company's paid parental leave policies cover all employees across its global operations.

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- **Regular performance appraisals and feedback processes**

Definition: Indicates whether and to what extent the company undertakes programs for employee professional development, such as performance reviews, goal setting and review, or similar. Best practice is for such programs to be provided to all permanent employees.

- **Skills and knowledge development training**

Definition: The extent of managerial/leadership development training. Best practice is a training program in which all employees participate.

Human Capital Development Performance score

The Human Capital Development Performance score evaluates the company's performance on human capital development metrics (including employee turnover and recognition as an employer of choice), relative to its peers. It is expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Employee turnover rate performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on reported employee turnover rate, and trend in employee turnover rate, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

  - **Employee turnover rate industry relative score**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on employee turnover rate relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

    - **Three-year average employee turnover rate**

    Definition: Measures the company's three-year average employee turnover rate.

  - **Employee turnover rate industry relative trend score**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average of year-over-year trend in employee turnover rate, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

    - **Three-year average employee turnover rate trend**

    Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year employee turnover rate trend.

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- **External recognition as employer of choice (last three years)**

Definition: Indicates whether the company received external recognition as an employer of choice in the last three years.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment.

- Labor management controversies.
- Collective bargaining controversies.
- Discrimination and workforce diversity controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Human Capital Development Exposure score

The Human Capital Development Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Company-Specific Exposure scores. The Business Exposure score is scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. The Company-Specific Exposure score functions as an addition to the Business Exposure score, with an additive impact of 0 to 2 points. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

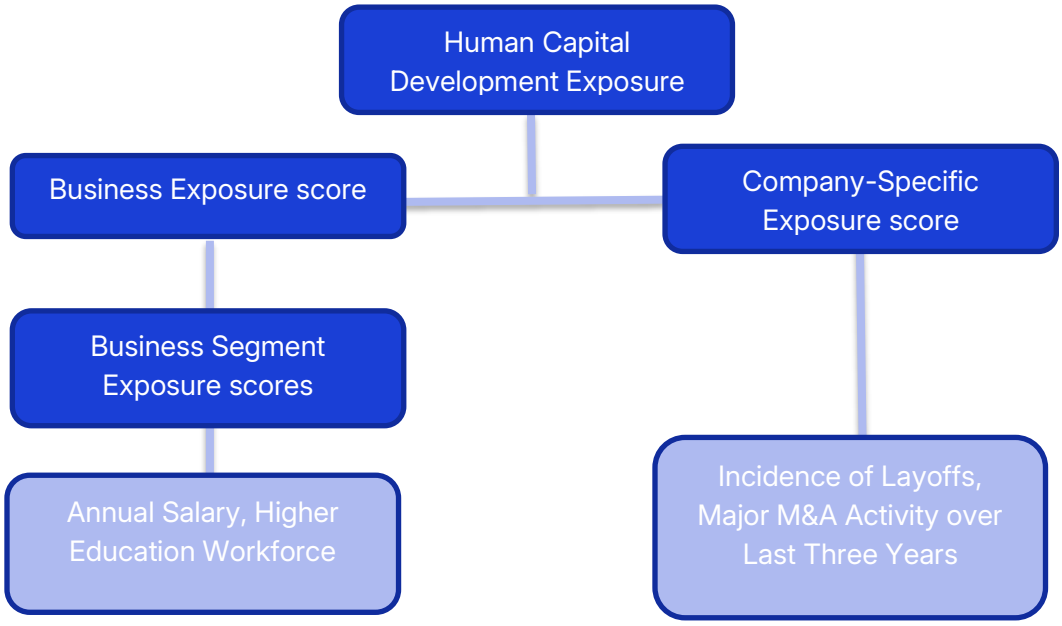
$$EXP_{HCD,i} = BUS_{HCD,i} + COM_{HCD,i}$$

Where:

- $EXP_{HCD,i}$ is the Human Capital Development Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{HCD,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $COM_{HCD,i}$ is the Company-Specific Exposure score of company i.

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Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total assets in each business segment,[2] using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{HCD,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Asset,i,j} BSE_{HCD,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{HCD,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Asset,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company assets.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

[2] The percentage of assets is typically calculated as the company-reported asset value of the segment divided by the total asset value. In certain cases, industry-specific metrics are used to calculate the percentage of assets, such as power generation, production volume or reserve value. In cases where neither segment assets nor a relevant industry-specific proxy is available, the percentage is calculated based on segment revenue.

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Business Segment Exposure scores

The Business Segment Exposure score is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is determined by a simple average of the Annual Salary score and the Higher Education Workforce score.

$$BSE_{HCD,j} = \frac{AS_j + HEW_j}{2}$$

Where:

- AS_j is the Annual Salary score for business activity j.
- HEW_j is the Higher Education Workforce score for business activity j.

The Annual Salary score and Higher Education Workforce score are based on a calculation that compares the relative ranking of a business activity on specific metrics (annual salaries and educational attainment of employees, respectively) to all other business activities on those same metrics. The Annual Salary score of a business activity is based on the 75th percentile of the annual salaries for each business activity. The Higher Education Workforce score is calculated based on the proportion of employees with Bachelor's Degree or higher for each business activity.

Company-Specific Exposure score

The Company-Specific Exposure score is an addition to the Business Exposure score, with an additive impact of 0 to 2 points.

The following formula is used to compute the Company-Specific Exposure score:

$$COM_{HCD,i} = ILO_{HCD,i} + IMA_{HCD,i}$$

Where:

- $ILO_{HCD,i}$ is the Incidence of Layoffs score of company i.
- $IMA_{HCD,i}$ is the Incidence of Major Mergers and Acquisitions score for company i.

The Incidence of Layoffs score is assessed as 1 if layoffs in the last three years affect more than 10% of the workforce or more than 1,000 employees per company; otherwise, it is assessed as 0. The Incidence of Major Mergers and Acquisitions score is assessed as 1 if major Mergers and Acquisitions activity in the

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last three years affects more than 10% of the workforce or more than 1,000 employees per company; otherwise, it is assessed as 0.

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Human Capital Development Exposure score:

Employment Projections Program, Bureau of Labor Statistics; Occupational Employment Statistics, Bureau of Labor Statistics; MSCI S&C; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

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